



The New Sherpa

Former NITI Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant will replace Piyush Goyal as India's Sherpa at G20. The appointment of Kant, a retired 1980-batch IAS officer, came just ahead of India assuming the G20 presidency on December 1, 2022, which it will hold till November 30, 2023. A full-time Sherpa was therefore needed. Also, the G20 Leaders' Summit will be held in India for the first time in 2023.

—RAJAT MISHRA

THE LONG ARM

ACKNOWLEDGING SOCIAL MEDIA to be a powerful tool with significant impact on the lives of citizens, the government has in the past held these platforms accountable for content posted. After micro-blogging site Twitter filed a petition in the Karnataka High Court to overturn some orders issued by the government on content takedown, IT and Electronics Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** said: "It's important to hold it [platforms] accountable, which will first start with self-regulation, then industry regulation, followed by government regulation."

—NIDHI SINGAL



Former Managing Director and Co-founder of BharatPe, Ashneer Grover, along with wife Madhuri Jain, has registered a new company, Third Unicorn, with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Third Strike



ASHNEER GROVER is starting up again after his acrimonious exit from BharatPe. Grover, along with wife Madhuri Jain, has registered a new company, Third Unicorn, with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. On his 40th birthday on June 14, Grover had announced that he's ready to 'disrupt another sector' with a new venture. Hopefully the new venture will work better for the entrepreneur.

—BINU PAUL

BLITZED!

After going back and forth on his proposed \$44-billion buyout of Twitter, **Elon Musk** has withdrawn his offer. The stock has been on a tailspin: It closed at \$44.48 on April 12, the day before Musk announced his offer of \$54.20 per share. On July 15, it closed at \$37.74. The last time he pulled a similar stunt—a failed bid in 2018 to take Tesla private—it cost him \$20 million in penalty to the US SEC and his chairmanship at the electric carmaker.

—VIDYA S.



GOOD TIMES, BAD TIMES

ONCE THE KING of good times, **Vijay Mallya** today finds it hard to stay out of controversy. The former liquor baron faces a four-month imprisonment in connection with a contempt case that goes back to 2017. The allegation then said Mallya had concealed the fact that a sum of \$40 million was received when he sold his holding in United Spirits to Diageo. With lenders already gunning for Mallya, the story has only got more complicated.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



Read my Lips

Gautam Adani's entry into the 5G telecom spectrum auctions is expected to heat up spectrum prices, giving tough competition to existing players—Mukesh Ambani's Jio Infocomm, Sunil Mittal's Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea. While Adani says he will keep spectrum usage restricted to B2B services, we will have to wait and watch the Adani Group's next steps in the telecom space.

—ARNAB DUTTA